GMAT Delivery-Mode Checklist

Online vs Test Center Comparison, Equipment Audits, Whiteboard Strategies & Test-Day Protocols

1. GMAT Online vs Test Center: Feature-by-Feature Matrix

Compare official GMAC delivery modes to select the environment that maximizes your cognitive focus and reduces stress.

Evaluation Parameter	GMAT Online Exam (At-Home)	GMAT Test Center Exam (In-Person)
Testing Location	Private, quiet room in your home or office with closed door	Official Pearson VUE testing center with proctored workstation
Scratchpad & Notes	Physical erasable whiteboard (max 12x20 in) + onscreen whiteboard	Laminated double-sided booklet (5 spiral sheets) + dry-erase pens
Room Constraints	Strict: No one may enter; no items on desk; clear walls	Standardized: Acoustically isolated testing carrel with divider
Hardware & Tech Risk	Candidate assumes all risk: Wi-Fi drop, laptop crash, webcam lag	Test center assumes responsibility; instant proctor assistance
Scheduling Flexibility	Available 24/7 round the clock; appointments every 15 minutes	Subject to center business hours and seat availability
Break Enforcement	10-minute break strictly monitored via webcam check-in/out	Biometric palm-vein scan at testing room exit/entry
Admissions Acceptance	100% equal acceptance; score report does NOT indicate delivery mode	100% equal acceptance across all global business schools

Official Policy: GMAC score reports sent to universities do not disclose whether you tested online or in a center.

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2. Equipment & Technical Readiness Checklist (Online GMAT)

Essential technical specifications required to prevent mid-exam disqualification by online proctors.

Requirement Dimension	Mandatory Technical Specification	Status [Tick]
Computer & OS	Windows 10/11 or macOS 11+; corporate VPNs and work laptops prohibited	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check
Webcam & Resolution	Continuous external or integrated webcam (minimum 720p 30fps)	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check
Microphone & Audio	Standard built-in mic/speakers; headphones and airpods strictly forbidden	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check
Internet Bandwidth	Reliable wired Ethernet or 5GHz Wi-Fi (minimum 10 Mbps download/upload)	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check
Physical Whiteboard	Whiteboard <= 12 x 20 inches with dry-erase marker and felt eraser	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check
Room Security	Single closed door, quiet space, zero dual monitors, no paper notes on walls	[ ] Verified / [ ] Needs Check

Warning: Using a corporate-managed laptop with enterprise security firewalls frequently blocks the OnVUE software.

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3. Test-Day Tactical Decision Guide

Rules for choosing between online and in-person based on your personal psychological profile.

- Choose Test Center if: You experience anxiety about internet drops, live in a noisy apartment, or write heavily on scratch paper.
- Choose Online if: You live > 2 hours from the nearest Pearson VUE center, prefer your own ergonomic chair, or test best at odd hours (e.g. 7 AM).
- Practice with the Exact Tool: If testing online, buy the exact 12x20 inch whiteboard and do 3 full mocks using it.
- Hybrid Retake Option: If your first test in a center suffered from noise or fatigue, GMAC allows you to retake online (and vice-versa).